

MIGHTIER THAN THE SWORD

BASIC RULES / 2-4 PLAYERS / THREE ACTS

SETUP

Use all 9 books in a random 3-by-3 grid. Each book has 2 pages. Edge-adjacent pages are 1 step apart, including the two halves of a book. Each player takes a protagonist, 10 Inklings and 12 matching-color memories (3 per row). Start with 4 Inklings in supply; reserve 3 for Act II and 3 for Act III. Cover all row upgrades with memories. Start at 0 points, with no characters. Shuffle the shared decks; deal 2 Twists and 1 face-up Subplot each. Place protagonists on any pages. The base pool has 15 conflict tokens, 5 per Act. Randomly select 1 per player for EACH Act; set the others aside. Put Act I's selected tokens on the main board. Choose a first player; turns run clockwise.

YOUR TURN

If your supply is empty at the start, shoot the moon (below). Otherwise move your protagonist up to your movement limit; staying is allowed. Then choose ONE action: place Inklings on its page using your Resolve level; upgrade one of your Inklings there; OR put 1 supply Inking in an empty activation square on a character card and use that action. Characters move only as their abilities allow and carry no Inklings. You may play 1 ON YOUR TURN Twist after moving, before or after your action; discard it. Finish rewards and Subplots, resolve full books, then discard to your Twist hand limit.

Inklings AND CHARACTERS

Place each Inking in an empty numbered space on your active page; if that page is full, use the book's shared overflow. Bonus placements also earn memory rewards; moving Inklings does not. Erase returns Inklings to their owner's current supply. Suspend sends an Inking to that owner's NEXT Act reserve (out of play in Act III). Foreshadow takes Inklings from your next Act reserve into supply; if unavailable, gain 1 point per Inking instead. Gain a character by drawing the top card and placing its figure with your protagonist. Characters and protagonists occupy no slots. Card Inklings stay until erased or the Act ends. A character move follows adjacent pages unless it says any page. Outside conflict, "here" means the acting character's page; overflow and conflicts belong to the whole book. If the character deck is empty, gain 2 points instead.

UPGRADE AND SHARE

Suspend one of your Inklings from a numbered space without a memory and replace it with the leftmost covered memory from any row. This improves that row level. The space stays empty until an Inking is placed there. A memory adds no power and stays unless a card returns it. Return it to the rightmost uncovered space in its row, lowering that row level; any Inking on it stays. Whenever an Inking is PLACED on it, the Inking's owner and memory's owner each gain its reward (once total if the same player). Resolve the placer's reward first. A Curiosity memory places the reward Inking in overflow on that same book. Extra upgrades still suspend your Inklings; if impossible, gain 2 points instead.

SUBPLOTS

Track only events that occur while your current Subplot is face up. Keep progress even if pieces move or disappear. When full, choose its character reward OR its alternative, then discard it and draw a new Subplot. The new card cannot count the event that completed the old one. Reshuffle Twist and Subplot discards when needed; draw only what is available.

CONFLICT

A book fights when all numbered spaces across BOTH pages are filled with Inklings; Agamemnon can count for 1 empty space. All players with Inklings, characters or a protagonist there participate, even at 0 power. Lock in participants; finish even if Inklings are erased. Reveal any Trojan Horse power first, then book and character start effects. Each participant may play 1 CONFLICT Twist in clockwise order from the active player; a raised limit allows 2. Keep going until all pass or reach their limit. Add Inklings (1 each), character power, protagonist Valor and effects. Highest power wins; ties go to the earliest participant clockwise from the active player. Discard ALL played Twists. Resolve win/loss effects and book after-effects, erase all Inklings from that book, then give the winner rewards. Figures and memories stay. Resolve other full books in the active player's chosen order.

CONFLICT REWARDS

EVERY conflict takes 1 available token from the current Act pool on the main board. The winner places it on the book and gains its strong bonus. If the book's +3 point space is uncovered, also score 3 times this new token's multiplier (Act I/II/III: $x1/x2/x3$), then cover that space. A covered book gives NO printed book points. Also gain each older token's face-up reward: its bonus if strong, or 1/2/3 points by its Act if on its back. Then flip all tokens there to their backs. Only the new token can multiply the book's points; never multiply token rewards. Choose the order of token rewards.

ACTS AND VICTORY

The last available token ends the Act: finish that conflict and its rewards, then end the turn. Leave other full books for the next turn; no conflict resolves without an available token. Or, if you START a turn with no supply Inklings, gain each unused current-Act token's strong bonus, without book points or multipliers; then end the Act. After Act III, most points wins; ties share victory. Otherwise flip tokens on books strong and uncover every book's +3 space, keeping its old tokens with it. Erase card Inklings, release the next reserve, prepare the Trojan Horse, and put the next Act's selected tokens on the main board. Leave book Inklings in place. The next player takes the next turn.

Current icon legend

Resources and memory rows use symbols. Actions and locations stay in words. Memories have a player-colored border, a large row symbol and a small reward reminder.

	Inkling Your limited supply of Inklings. Each Inkling on a book contributes 1 power.		Curiosity Movement row. Memory reward:  place 1 Inkling into overflow on this book.
	Protagonist Your quill and inkwell figure. Its power comes from Valor.		Valor Protagonist power row. Memory reward: gain 1 plot point.
	Character Draw the top character card when you gain one.		Insight Hand-limit row. Memory reward: draw 1 Twist.
	Twist The shared deck of special effects.		Resolve Placement row. Memory reward: foreshadow 1 Inkling.
	Plot points Your score. The most plot points wins.		During conflict A passive combat ability; no activation Inklings required.
	Foreshadow Inklings Take Inklings from your next Act reserve into your current supply.		Other passive Use the printed timing; no activation Inklings required.

	Activation square Put one of your supply Inklings here to use the adjacent character action. Each square can hold one Inkling.		Memory hexagon A memory improves its board row and stays on a book space. It adds no power and does not fill the space.
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Erase = return to current supply. **Suspend** = send to next Act reserve.
Overflow = extra Inklings on a book, outside numbered spaces. It adds power but never fills a space.

Journey to the Center of the Earth

The Underground Sea

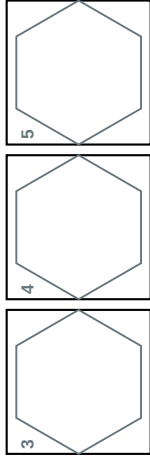
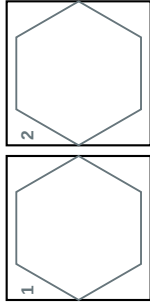
VOYAGES

CONFLICT

+3

 DURING CONFLICT

Each player with at least 1 Inking in overflow here has +2 power.



OVERFLOW

The Odyssey

The Journey

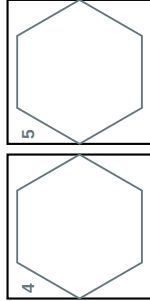
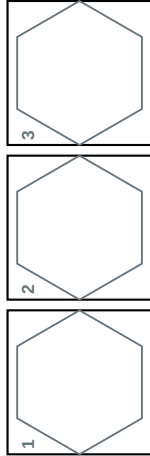
EPICS

CONFLICT

+3

 AFTER CONFLICT

Each participant gains 1  per memory row they have upgraded at least once.



OVERFLOW

20,000 Leagues Under the Sea

In the Submarine

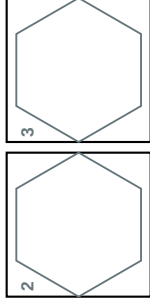
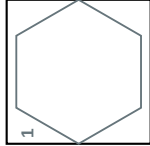
VOYAGES

CONFLICT

+3

 ALWAYS

No overflow. Any Inking sent to overflow here drowns; erase it immediately.



NO OVERFLOW / incoming overflow Inklings are erased

Around the World in Eighty Days

The Railway Station

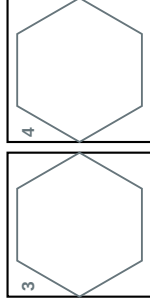
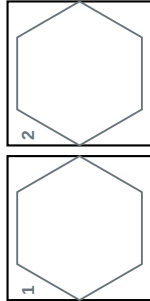
VOYAGES

CONFLICT

+3

 AFTER CONFLICT

Each participant may move their protagonist to any page.



OVERFLOW

Dracula

Castle Dracula

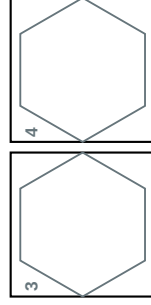
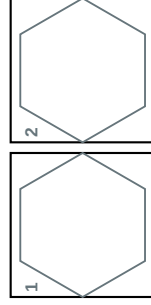
GOTHIC HORROR

CONFLICT



BEFORE CONFLICT

Each participant may erase 1 of their Inklings here to gain +2 power for this conflict.



OVERFLOW

Frankenstein

The Laboratory

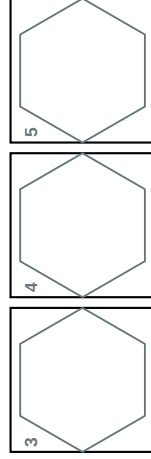
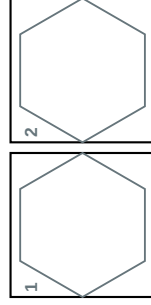
GOTHIC HORROR

CONFLICT



AFTER CONFLICT

Each participant may foreshadow 1 Inking.



OVERFLOW

The Iliad

Troy

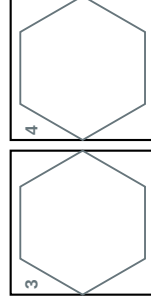
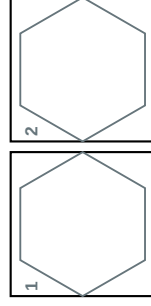
EPICS

CONFLICT



DURING CONFLICT

If you have exactly 1 Inking here when you play a Twist, gain +3 power for this conflict.



OVERFLOW

Beowulf

The Mead Hall

EPICS

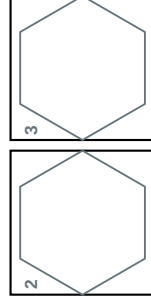
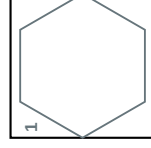
CONFLICT

3 +



DURING CONFLICT

Your first character here has +1 power.



OVERFLOW

Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde

The London Street

BEFORE CONFLICT

✂

Each participant may discard 1 Twist to draw 1 Twist.

1

2

3

OVERFLOW

GOTHIC HORROR

CONFLICT

+3

★

TWIST A Hero Provoked CONFLICT Gain +3 power, plus +3 if you have a character here. <i>"Sing, O goddess, the anger of Achilles"</i> The Iliad 01	TWIST Doom Defied CONFLICT Gain +5 power. <i>"Fares Wyrd as she must."</i> Beowulf 02	TWIST Travelling Light CONFLICT Gain +6 power if you have exactly 1 Inkling here; otherwise gain +2 power. <i>"A well-used minimum suffices for everything."</i> Around the World in Eighty Days 03
TWIST Engines of Discovery CONFLICT Gain +2 power. Move up to 2 of your Inklings from other books into overflow here. <i>"This agent is electricity."</i> Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea 04	TWIST The Nameless Stratagem CONFLICT Gain +2 power. One opposing character contributes no power in this conflict. Its abilities still work. <i>"my name is Noman"</i> The Odyssey 05	TWIST A Costly Experiment CONFLICT Gain +2 power. You may erase up to 2 of your Inklings here; gain +3 power for each erased. <i>"We learn from failure, not from success!"</i> Dracula 06
TWIST The Outcast's Revenge CONFLICT Gain +3 power. If you lose, erase 1 opposing Inkling on another book. <i>"Beware, for I am fearless and therefore powerful."</i> Frankenstein 07	TWIST A Lasting Legend CONFLICT Gain +3 power. If you win, gain 2 extra 🌟 <i>"glory ere death!"</i> Beowulf 08	TWIST Mathematical Leap ON YOUR TURN Move your protagonist to any page. <i>"Quite possible, on the contrary"</i> Around the World in Eighty Days 09

TWIST An Ocean Without Borders ON YOUR TURN Move up to 3 of your Inklings from other books into overflow at your protagonist's book. "The sea is everything." Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea 10	TWIST Crossing the Threshold ON YOUR TURN Foreshadow 2 Inklings. "Our real journey had now commenced." Journey to the Center of the Earth 11	TWIST Divine Favor ON YOUR TURN Make 1 extra upgrade on your protagonist's page by suspending 1 of your Inklings there. "in the hands of the immortal gods" The Iliad 12
TWIST An Unlikely Champion ON YOUR TURN Return 1 of your memories from your protagonist's book to draw 1 character. "Tell me, O Muse, of that ingenious hero" The Odyssey 13	TWIST Stolen Vitality ON YOUR TURN Erase 1 opposing Inkling on your protagonist's page. Then place 1 of yours in its old space, gaining any memory reward. "The blood is the life!" Dracula 14	TWIST A Hero Returns ON YOUR TURN Erase up to 2 of your activation Inklings from character cards. "Be of good courage" The Odyssey 15
SUBPLOT The Unfinished Map Mark 1 whenever your protagonist finishes its normal move on a different book from where it started. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 16	SUBPLOT A Name in Every Song Mark 1 whenever you make an upgrade. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Gain 4 Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 17	SUBPLOT Traveling Companions Mark 1 whenever you activate a character or make an upgrade. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Erase up to 3 of your activation Inklings from character cards. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 18

SUBPLOT The Gathering Mark 1 for each Inkling you place in a numbered book space, including bonus placements. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Place up to 2 Inklings into overflow at your protagonist's book. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 19	SUBPLOT Beyond the Horizon Mark 1 for each Inkling you foreshadow with a card, token or memory reward. Normal Act releases do not count. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Draw 2 Twists. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 20	SUBPLOT The Shared Story Mark 1 whenever another player places an Inkling on a space with one of your memories. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Gain 4 Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 21
SUBPLOT A Tale Worth Telling Mark 1 whenever you play a Twist. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 22	SUBPLOT Into the Fray Mark 1 for each conflict you participate in, whether you win or lose. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Gain 4 Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 23	SUBPLOT The Empty House Mark 1 for each Inkling you erase from a book with an ability or Twist. Conflict cleanup does not count. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Draw 2 Twists. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 24
SUBPLOT A Second Chance Mark 1 whenever you place an Inkling on a space with any player's memory. WHEN FULL, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1 OR Make 1 extra upgrade on your protagonist's page by suspending 1 of your Inklings there. Then discard this and draw a new Subplot. 25	CHARACTER POWER 1 Dracula GOTHIC HORROR Move Dracula up to 1 page. You may erase 1 opposing Inkling here, then place 1 of yours in its old space and gain its memory reward. 26	CHARACTER POWER 0 Frankenstein GOTHIC HORROR COLLECT YOUR ERASED Inklings When one of your Inklings is erased from a book, you may put it in an empty collection space here instead. At 3 Inklings, Frankenstein has 5 power and may move 1 page at the end of your turn. 27

CHARACTERPOWER 1 Jekyll GOthic HORROR Flip a coin. Heads: move Jekyll up to 1 page, then place up to 2 Inklings into overflow here. Tails: erase 1 opposing Inking here. 28 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 3 Achilles EPICS Move Achilles up to 1 page. Erase 1 opposing Inking on Achilles' page. 29 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 0 Trojan Horse EPICS Move the Trojan Horse up to 2 pages. ✗ When gained and at each Act start, hide 1 of its 5 power cards here. Reveal it at this book's next conflict; it lasts for that conflict, then stays spent until the next Act. 30 </td></td>	CHARACTERPOWER 3 Achilles EPICS Move Achilles up to 1 page. Erase 1 opposing Inking on Achilles' page. 29 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 0 Trojan Horse EPICS Move the Trojan Horse up to 2 pages. ✗ When gained and at each Act start, hide 1 of its 5 power cards here. Reveal it at this book's next conflict; it lasts for that conflict, then stays spent until the next Act. 30 </td>	CHARACTERPOWER 0 Trojan Horse EPICS Move the Trojan Horse up to 2 pages. ✗ When gained and at each Act start, hide 1 of its 5 power cards here. Reveal it at this book's next conflict; it lasts for that conflict, then stays spent until the next Act. 30
CHARACTERPOWER 1 Agamemnon EPICS Move Agamemnon up to 2 pages. ✗ For triggering conflict only, Agamemnon counts as filling 1 empty Inking space here. He occupies no slot. You may play up to 2 Twists here instead of 1. 31 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 2 Odysseus EPICS Move Odysseus up to 3 pages. ✗ Whenever you play a Twist in a conflict here, draw 1 Twist. 32 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 1 Captain Nemo VOYAGES Move Nemo to any page. ✗ Before Twists are played, you may move any activation Inklings from this card into overflow at Nemo's book. This empties those activation spaces. 33 </td></td>	CHARACTERPOWER 2 Odysseus EPICS Move Odysseus up to 3 pages. ✗ Whenever you play a Twist in a conflict here, draw 1 Twist. 32 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 1 Captain Nemo VOYAGES Move Nemo to any page. ✗ Before Twists are played, you may move any activation Inklings from this card into overflow at Nemo's book. This empties those activation spaces. 33 </td>	CHARACTERPOWER 1 Captain Nemo VOYAGES Move Nemo to any page. ✗ Before Twists are played, you may move any activation Inklings from this card into overflow at Nemo's book. This empties those activation spaces. 33
CHARACTERPOWER 1 Phileas Fogg VOYAGES Move Fogg to any page. Then you may move your protagonist to any page. 34 <td> CHARACTERPOWER 2 Ichthyosaur VOYAGES Put Ichthyosaur between any 2 edge-adjacent pages on different books. ∞ Ichthyosaur is present on both adjoining pages and contributes power in either book's conflict. 35 <td> HORSE POWER Secret Army TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✗ Before Twists, place up to 3 Inklings from your supply into overflow here. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 36 </td></td>	CHARACTERPOWER 2 Ichthyosaur VOYAGES Put Ichthyosaur between any 2 edge-adjacent pages on different books. ∞ Ichthyosaur is present on both adjoining pages and contributes power in either book's conflict. 35 <td> HORSE POWER Secret Army TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✗ Before Twists, place up to 3 Inklings from your supply into overflow here. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 36 </td>	HORSE POWER Secret Army TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✗ Before Twists, place up to 3 Inklings from your supply into overflow here. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 36

HORSE POWER Strategists TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER  You may play up to 2 Twists here instead of 1. This does not add to Agamemnon's limit. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 37	HORSE POWER Tribute to the Gods TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER  If you win this conflict, gain 4 extra 🌟 Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 38	HORSE POWER All Part of the Plan TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER  If you win this conflict, complete your current Subplot, regardless of its progress. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 39
HORSE POWER I Know Your Weakness TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER  Ignore all other characters' power and abilities at this book for this conflict. Effects already resolved are not undone. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 40		



Cover each row with 3 matching memories. Uncover left to right.



CURIOSITY

Move 1 page



Move 2 pages



Move 3 pages



Move 4 pages

MEMORIES

Place one Inking into overflow.



VALOR

Protagonist power 0



Power 1



Power 2



Power 3

MEMORIES

Gain 1 ⭐



INSIGHT

Twist hand limit 3



Hand limit 4



Hand limit 5



Hand limit 6

MEMORIES

Draw 1 Twist.



RESOLVE

Place 1 Inking



Discard 1 Twist to place 2, or place 1 free



Place up to 2 Inkings



Place up to 3 Inkings

MEMORIES

Foreshadow 1 Inking.

ACT II RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

ACT III RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings



Cover each row with 3 matching memories. Uncover left to right.



CURIOSITY

Move 1 page



Move 2 pages



Move 3 pages



Move 4 pages

MEMORIES

Place one Inking into overflow.



VALOR

Protagonist power 0



Power 1



Power 2



Power 3

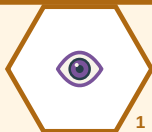
MEMORIES

Gain 1 ⭐

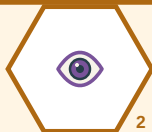


INSIGHT

Twist hand limit 3



Hand limit 4



Hand limit 5



Hand limit 6

MEMORIES

Draw 1 Twist.



RESOLVE

Place 1 Inking



Discard 1 Twist to place 2, or place 1 free



Place up to 2 Inkings



Place up to 3 Inkings

MEMORIES

Foreshadow 1 Inking.

ACT II RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

ACT III RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

Plot points



0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59
79	78	77	76	75	74	73	72	71	70	69	68	67	66	65	64	63	62	61	60
80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99

ACT

I

II

III

AVAILABLE TOKENS / CURRENT ACT

Every conflict takes 1 token from this pool. Its last token ends the Act.

CONFLICT REWARDS

Uncovered book: +3 ★ times the new token's multiplier.
Covered book: no printed book points.
Gain the new bonus and each older token's face-up reward; flip all to their backs.

END OF ACT

Last token used, or a player starts with no Inklings.
Flip book tokens strong; uncover book VP spaces.
Erase character-card Inklings; release the next reserve.
Prepare Trojan Horse and the next Act's token pool.

Memories

12 per player / 3 per row

 Teal / orbit



 Amber / prism



 Rose / petals



 Violet / chevrons



ACT I	ACT I	ACT I	ACT I	ACT I
A New Chapter Draw 1 character. x1	Fresh Inklings Foreshadow 2 Inklings. x1	Revision Make 1 extra upgrade at any book. x1	Inspiration Draw 2  . Foreshadow 1 Inking. x1	Second Wind Erase up to 2 activation  . Draw 1  x1
ACT II	ACT II	ACT II	ACT II	ACT II
A Rising Star Draw 1 character. Gain 2  . x2	New Possibilities Make 1 extra upgrade at any book. Draw 2  x2	A Wider World Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Gain 2  x2	Renewed Purpose Erase up to 3 activation  . Gain 2  x2	A Bold Turn Draw 2  . Gain 3  x2
ACT III	ACT III	ACT III	ACT III	ACT III
A Lasting Legacy Gain 6  x3	The Final Twist Draw 2  . Gain 4  x3	A Hero's Farewell Gain 4  . Erase up to 2 activation  x3	The Final Revision Make 1 extra upgrade at any book. Gain 4  x3	An Encore Draw 1 character. Gain 4  x3

ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 
ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 
ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 